

Outlook

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Are distressed customers entering the right pathway?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Collections needs to distinguish temporary operational failures, short-term cash-flow stress and sustained affordability problems. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if repeat failures and complaints indicate deeper stress?
2. What evidence would instead support that some customers recover after payday?
3. How do we rule out that bank-side processing issues are entering collections?

Please work towards which treatment path, contact tone and escalation should apply. A useful output would be a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review.

Use collections cases, promises to pay and recovery payments; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions; the latest closed loan files available by the request date, including affordability, pricing and origination risk fields. One caution: The data contains behavioural indicators, not a complete vulnerability or hardship assessment.

Regards